

Bunnies Multiply in Silence

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Executive summary

Bunnies are cute and harmless, but if you stop watching, they multiply in silence.

This manifesto records a governance-first stance: build systems that compound without coercion, scale without extracting rent, and endure without requiring a permanent founder. It treats power as a risk surface, not a reward. It treats speed as a tool, not a virtue. It treats legacy as maximum durability under entropy, not personal immortality.

The scaffolding is PAD-0001: Pre-AGI Dossier Zero: an invariant-driven approach that prioritises human agency, epistemic integrity, distributed authority, and resilience under scrutiny. [\[filecite\turn0file0\]](#) The purpose is to declare institutional constraints early, before scale creates bargaining power, before capital creates dependency, and before narrative becomes indistinguishable from ego.

The practical result: a HoldCo that refuses venture escalation rounds as a design principle; an operating layer that earns legitimacy through service; governance mechanisms that survive founder absence; and a terminal personal horizon that is domestic, not imperial.

Origin — The Open Cage

I have known since adolescence that I did not want to live as a traditional careerist. I did not want the default bargain of permission-based advancement: credentials exchanged for conformity, promotions exchanged for dependence, status exchanged for silence.

The cage was never locked. The constraints were largely invisible: social scripts, fear of scarcity, and the quiet pressure to be legible to institutions that only reward familiar paths.

Agency returned when I stopped asking whether my life plan was “reasonable” and began asking whether it was coherent. I proved—through disciplined exposure to high-variance opportunity—that financial insecurity could be reduced without surrendering autonomy. That proof was not a trophy. It was a release valve: it lowered the emotional cost of choosing slower, harder, governance-heavy paths.

The Lab exists to make that agency durable. Not as rebellion, and not as a personality cult, but as an institutional answer to a common failure mode: founders who speak about values only after scale forces them to compromise.

Principle — Silent Compounding

Silent compounding is a design choice: to accumulate capability, trust, and structural necessity without theatricality.

In institutional terms, it means compounding is operational, not performative. Evidence beats narrative. Systems improve through repeated cycles of small, verifiable wins: better governance hygiene, clearer decision logs, tighter accountability, fewer single points of failure.

It means compounding is non-coercive. Growth must not depend on capturing users, locking counterparties, or manufacturing dependence. The goal is to be chosen repeatedly, not endured.

It means compounding is legible to scrutiny. The organisation must be able to explain what it does, why it does it, and how it stays inside its own constraints. If a practice requires secrecy to remain acceptable, it is structurally unstable.

It means compounding is distribution-aware. Power concentrates by default. If left unaddressed, any successful system becomes a magnet for rent-seeking, status games, and institutional capture. Silent compounding therefore includes an obligation to design counterweights early.

Governance Alignment

This manifesto adopts PAD-style governance logic: invariants first, optimisation second. The following clauses are explicit and non-negotiable.

No absolute power. No single person, committee, or system shall hold irrevocable absolute power. Authority must be revocable, auditable, and constrained by process. When speed conflicts with revocability, revocability wins.

Distributed authority by design. Decision rights shall be decomposed into roles with clear domains, documented escalation paths, and credible veto points. Distributed authority is not democracy-as-performance; it is redundancy against human error, conflict of interest, and moral drift.

Long-horizon durability. We optimise for survivability across decades, not dominance across quarters. When incentives push toward fragile short-term wins, the organisation must pay the “alignment tax” willingly: slower decisions, extra review, and deliberate refusal of certain profitable shortcuts.

Systems must survive founder absence. Founder presence is not an acceptable single point of failure. Processes, operator handbooks, and governance artefacts must make it possible for competent successors to operate without mythology. This is a requirement, not a preference.

Alignment over speed. We will choose slower paths when the faster path increases the probability of drift, coercion, or irreversible harm. “Move fast and break things” is disallowed where the broken thing is trust, rights, or institutional legitimacy.

Epistemic integrity as infrastructure. Truthfulness, audibility, and disciplined uncertainty-handling are treated as core infrastructure, not public relations. If we cannot explain a decision plainly, we treat it as incomplete.

The governance commitments below are the minimum bar; they are written to be executable.

Item	Commitment	Practical implication
Power	No irrevocable absolute power	Formal vetoes, multi-party approvals for high-impact actions
Oversight	Distributed authority	Clear decision domains; escalation paths; independent review
Time horizon	Long-horizon durability	Prefer resilient compounding over hyper-growth
Founder risk	System survives founder absence	Documented playbooks; succession and delegation built in
Integrity	Epistemic integrity	Decision logs, falsifiable claims, explicit uncertainty tracking
Tempo	Alignment > speed	Slow down when incentives distort behaviour

Anti-Empire Clause

The HoldCo will not take Series A, Series B, or Series C financing. This is not a moral performance. It is a governance constraint: venture escalation rounds reliably introduce growth mandates that compete with alignment mandates.

Grants may be accepted only when they are demonstrably non-distorting. “Non-distorting” means: the grant does not create agenda capture, does not require narrative contortions, does not introduce dependency that changes internal decision rights, and does not force timeline commitments that bypass governance checks.

Capital must not dictate values. Capital can purchase outputs; it does not purchase the right to rewrite invariants. Where funding terms conflict with the clauses in this manifesto, the correct action is refusal, even when refusal is costly.

This clause exists to prevent a predictable institutional failure mode: replacing governance with fundraising, and mistaking external validation for internal coherence.

Legacy Without Tyranny

Legacy is often confused with control. This manifesto rejects that confusion.

The aim is maximum durability under entropy: the highest probability that what is built remains useful, interpretable, and ethically bounded long after the founder’s preferences, language, and personal story no longer matter.

This requires three practical commitments.

First, encode values as constraints, not slogans. Values that exist only in speech can be renegotiated under pressure; values that exist in process are harder to erase.

Second, preserve knowledge in durable, portable forms. Governance artefacts, operator checklists, and explicit definitions should be versioned, amended, and archived so that future stewards can understand the original intent without needing to mythologise the founder. PAD-0001's emphasis on interpretability across time and its template for controlled evolution are treated as baseline hygiene.

Third, design for plural stewardship. Durable institutions outlive individuals by allowing successors to modify tactics while protecting invariants.

If the system cannot survive without me, then I failed.

Terminal State

The personal arc is not “founder forever”. It is Romance→Discipline→Structure→Romance.

Romance, at the beginning, is not fantasy. It is a commitment to continuity: to family, to care, to the long obligations that cannot be solved by money or status. Discipline is the proof phase: building competence, earning freedom from necessity, and learning to operate in reality rather than aspiration. Structure is the institutional phase: converting values into governance, and converting personal agency into organisational durability. Romance, at the end, is the return: choosing presence over power.

Control is not the objective. Stewardship is. The long-horizon target is 50% stewardship: enough influence to defend invariants, insufficient scope to become an unaccountable monarch. Operational authority must be delegated; governance authority must be constrained.

The end-state is domestic: to be a househusband, to raise children, and to treat institutional work as stewardship performed in service of a life that remains human-scale. This is not retreat. It is the statement that the institution is a tool, not an identity.

Closing

A manifesto is a public constraint. Once published, it becomes a reputational anchor that future decisions will be measured against. That is the point: to reduce the probability of drift by raising the cost of rationalising drift.

Publishing next steps, designed for a LinkedIn article:

Timing: publish after the governance blueprint reaches “operational completeness” (clear roles, veto points, documentation baseline), but before major scale or external capital introduces incentive distortion.

Audience: long-horizon operators, governance-minded collaborators, and counterparties who value constraints and clarity over speed. If the piece attracts only those who want hyper-growth or founder worship, it has failed its filtering function.

Reputational risks: being misread as anti-growth (rather than pro-durability), being seen as inflexible, or being framed as signalling rather than commitment. Mitigation is procedural: publish the manifesto alongside a visible, boring implementation artefact (a governance checklist or decision process diagram) to demonstrate it is executable, not aspirational.

A simple three-scenario risk matrix for publication:

Scenario	What happens after publication	One-line mitigation
Best	The manifesto filters collaborators toward integrity; governance becomes a compounding advantage	Maintain a public change-log of governance practices to prove consistency
Likely	The piece is niche; it attracts a small, high-trust circle and modestly raises switching costs	Re-post annually with an execution update and any amendments
Worst	The manifesto is used against you when reality forces tactical change; accusations of hypocrisy appear	Write an amendment protocol now: what can change, what cannot, and who can approve changes

Bunnies do not conquer the forest; they persist, and in time the forest reconfigures around what they quietly sustain.